2026

YEAR 3

SEMESTER 1

UNIVERSITY OF THE WITWATERSRAND- BAS

Architecture

PORTFOLIO



TAMAE SAISHA REDDY



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arch.tamae

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Johannesburg, South Africa

about me...

I'm a third-year architecture student at the University of the Witwatersrand, interested in designing spaces that feel considered, responsive, and genuinely connected to the people who use them. I'm drawn to the idea that good architecture sits somewhere between function and feeling. It works well, but it also creates atmosphere through light, air, material, and movement. My process moves between digital tools and hand drawing, using each to test and understand ideas rather than just represent them. I'm especially interested in sustainable and passive design, and how simple, thoughtful strategies can shape comfortable environments that respond to climate and context. An important method of design to me, is model making, I am extremely passionate about it and will continue to use it as tool for design. Alongside architecture, I've worked in art and graphic design, which has strengthened how I communicate ideas visually and approach composition with more intention.



WORK EXPERIENCE

2024
SAGNELLI ARCHITECTS-DURBAN
Architecture Intern

- Assisted in the early conceptual design phase of a residential project, contributing tospatial ideas and layout development
- Produced Revit and AutoCAD drawings to support design proposals
- Developed 3D models and visual representations to communicate design intent Participated in internal discussions and design reviews, gaining exposure to professional workflow
- Supported the translation of concept ideas into clear, presentable drawings

2023 – PRESENT
Freelance Design Work Graphic Designer & Artist

- Created brand identities and logo designs for local businesses
- Produced commissioned artwork for private clients
- Developed visual content including posters, digital graphics, and illustrations
- Managed client communication and
- translated briefs into clear visual outcomes

2026
SAOTA – Student Internship

- Collaborated with a SAOTA architect through one-on-one mentorship to design a bespoke family residence from concept to presentation.
- Developed the project using Revit, producing coordinated BIM models and architectural documentation.
- Gained exposure to SAOTA's residential design philosophy, workflow, and design review process.
- Participated in site visits to completed SAOTA residences, engaging directly with homeowners to understand client needs and post-occupancy experience.
- Produced architectural visualisations using Twinmotion, AI-assisted rendering workflows, and presentation software.
- Explored computational design fundamentals using Dynamo and digital design tools to support the design process.
- Presented design proposals and received iterative critique from architects, strengthening design communication and collaborative problem-solving.

VOLUNTEER WORK

2026- Present
Hands for Hunger Johannesburg

Assist in food distribution initiatives supporting vulnerable communities Participate in organising and preparing community outreach efforts

2024 – Present
Sivananda Divine Life Society

Involved in community-based activities and service initiatives
Support events focused on well-being and social upliftment

High School
Anti-Drug Awareness Forum

Participated in peer awareness campaigns promoting healthy lifestyles Engaged in discussions and initiatives addressing substance abuse among youth

EDUCATION

2024 – 2026
University of the Witwatersrand (Wits)
Bachelor of Architectural Studies (Final Year)
2019 – 2023
Newhaven Secondary School, Durban
National Senior Certificate

HIGH SCHOOL EXPERIENCE
Subjects Completed

- Physical Science
- Mathematics
- Engineering, Graphics and Design
- Life Science
- English
- Afrikaans
- Life Orientation

SKILLS

DESIGN SKILLS

- Concept development & spatial thinking Contextual & site-responsive design
- Hand drawing & architectural thinking
- Passive / climate-responsive design
- Architectural representation (sections, diagrams, plans)
- Model making with real materials

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Revit (modelling + documentation) AutoCAD (drafting)
- SKETCHUP 3D modeling
- Graphic layout & composition
- Adobe software (Photoshop,Illustrator,Indesign)
- Procreate

SOFT SKILLS

- Graphic design (branding, posters)
- Commissioned artwork
- Visual storytelling

INTERESTS

Climate-responsive and passive design
Water systems and environmental integration in architecture
Hand drawing and architectural sketching
Art, graphic design, and visual storytelling
Community engagement and social impact
Cultural expression in architecture
Photography
Model making

UNIVERSITY ACCOLADES

2025- Gauteng institute for architecture 1st year award

UNIVERSITY ACHIEVEMENTS

2024 – 2025 | UNIVERSITY OF THE WITWATERSRAND

- Distinction — Building Ecology I
- Distinction — Histories & Theories of Architecture I/II
- Distinction — Introduction to Structures II
- Distinction — Design Representation (Sound Design) II



MANIFESTO



TSISIKAMMA HIKERS
SHELTER



SOCIAL HOUSING IN
MELVILLE



KAIRA LOORO COMPETITION
COMMUNITY CENTRE



RESIDENCE
SAOTA INTERNSHIP



Architecture, for me, begins with people...

I believe meaningful spaces are not defined solely by their form, but by the experiences, emotions, and interactions they enable. My work is driven by an interest in atmosphere. *How does light, material, sound, texture, and movement influence the way people perceive and inhabit space?*

I approach architecture as the design of **ecosystems** rather than isolated objects. Buildings exist within larger networks of people, cultures, landscapes, climates, and urban systems. As a designer, I am interested in understanding these relationships and creating environments that contribute positively to the social and ecological **fabric of a place**.

Materiality plays a central role in my design process. I am fascinated by the way **materials** communicate character, memory, craft, and permanence. Whether through the solidity of masonry, the lightness of steel, or the tactile qualities of natural materials, I strive to create architecture that can be experienced through both the eye and the body.

My work seeks to balance rational problem-solving with curiosity and exploration. I am drawn to projects that challenge conventional ways of living, learning, and working, while remaining grounded in the needs of the people who use them. I believe architecture should foster connection, discovery, wellbeing, and a sense of belonging.

Ultimately, I aspire to create spaces that are **thoughtful**, **atmospheric**, and **deeply human-centred**...*architecture that functions as a living ecosystem, enriching everyday life through meaningful experiences, social interaction, and an enduring relationship between people, place, and environment.*





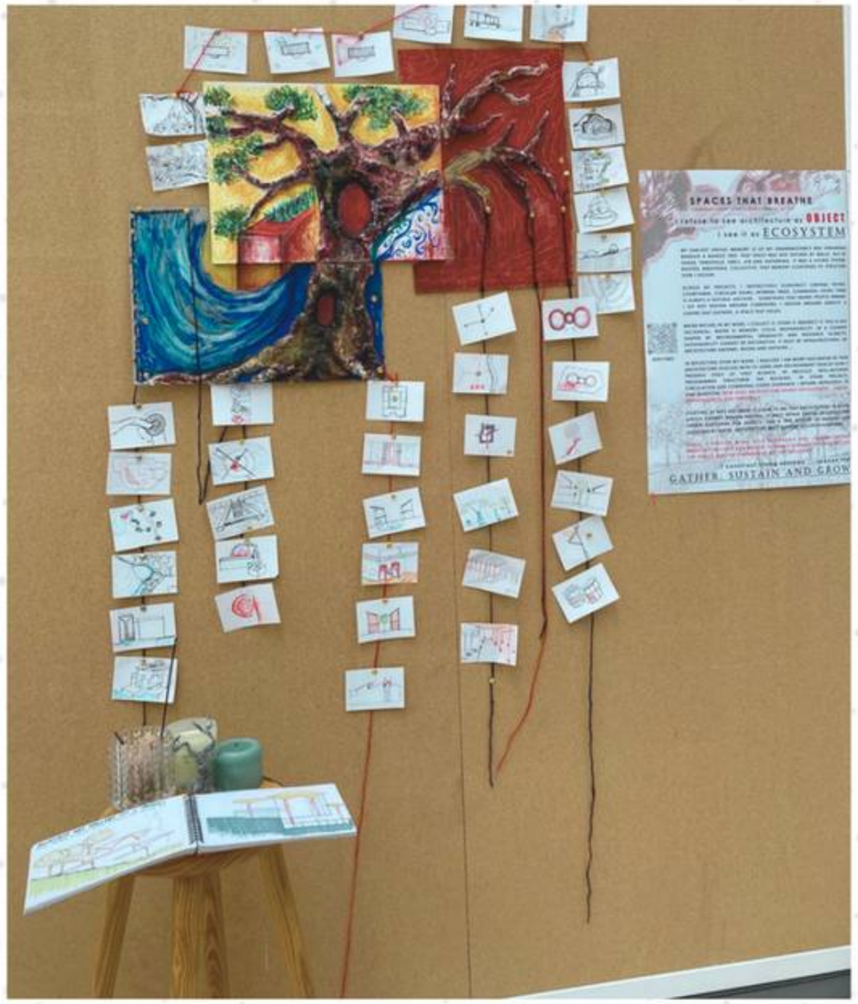


PROJECT 1

MANIFESTO

I believe architecture is most meaningful when it places people at its centre. Through materiality, atmosphere, and an understanding of the ecosystems in which buildings exist, I strive to create spaces that foster connection, curiosity, wellbeing, and a lasting sense of belonging.




SPACES THAT BREATHE
GATHER, SUSTAIN AND GROW


SPACES THAT BREATHE
GATHER, SUSTAIN AND GROW







KEY PRINCIPLES

- *HUMAN EXPERIENCE*
- *MATERIALITY & ATMOSPHERE*
- *ECOLOGICAL THINKING*
- *CONNECTION & COMMUNITY*
- *CURIOSITY & PLAY*



YOS2

LEAVE NO TRACE

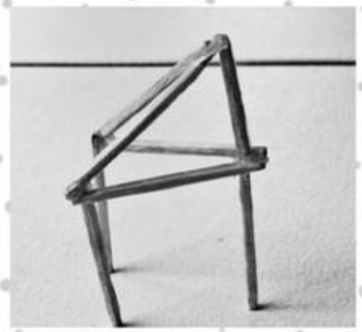
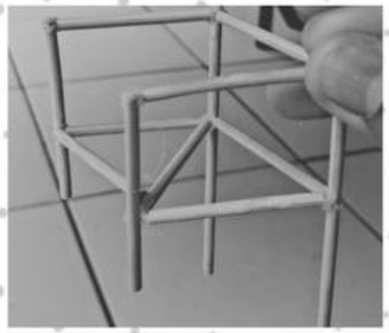
TIMBER SHELTER

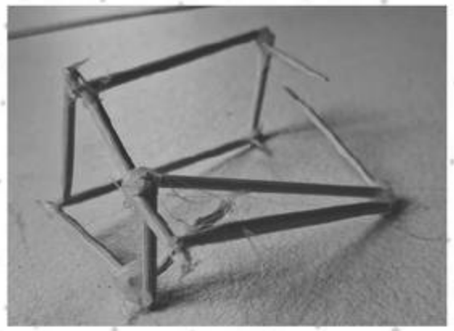
TSITSIKAMMA, EASTERN CAPE

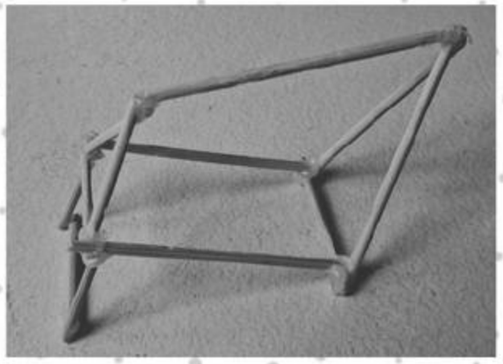
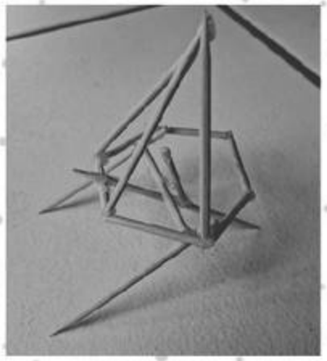
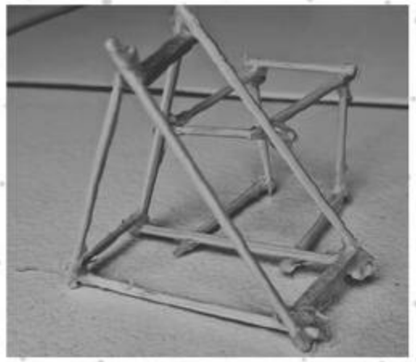
Designing a timber hiking shelter taught me how structure, material, and landscape work together. This project helped me connect deeply with the environment through making and material honesty.

1:100 CONCEPT MODELS

exploring different forms, this process inspired the idea of a walk-on roof





selected conceptual model

1:50 PROCESS MODEL

Through the 1:100 models I became drawn to the idea of height and movement — how the body relates to the fall of water. The 1:50 model refined this, exploring a walk-on roof that lets users experience the landscape and water from above with the view of the waterfall.












The 1:25 model explored the balance between structure and landscape. I aimed to translate the natural slopes and materials into a compact, experiential form.









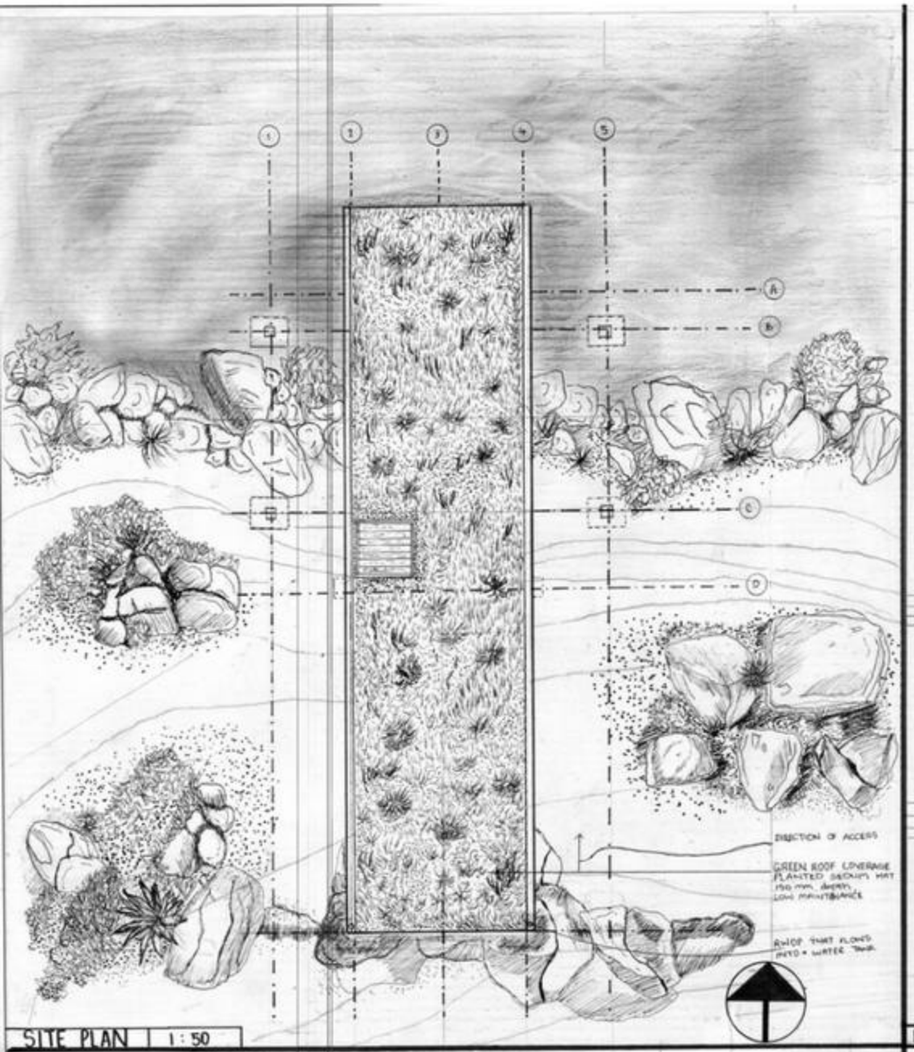




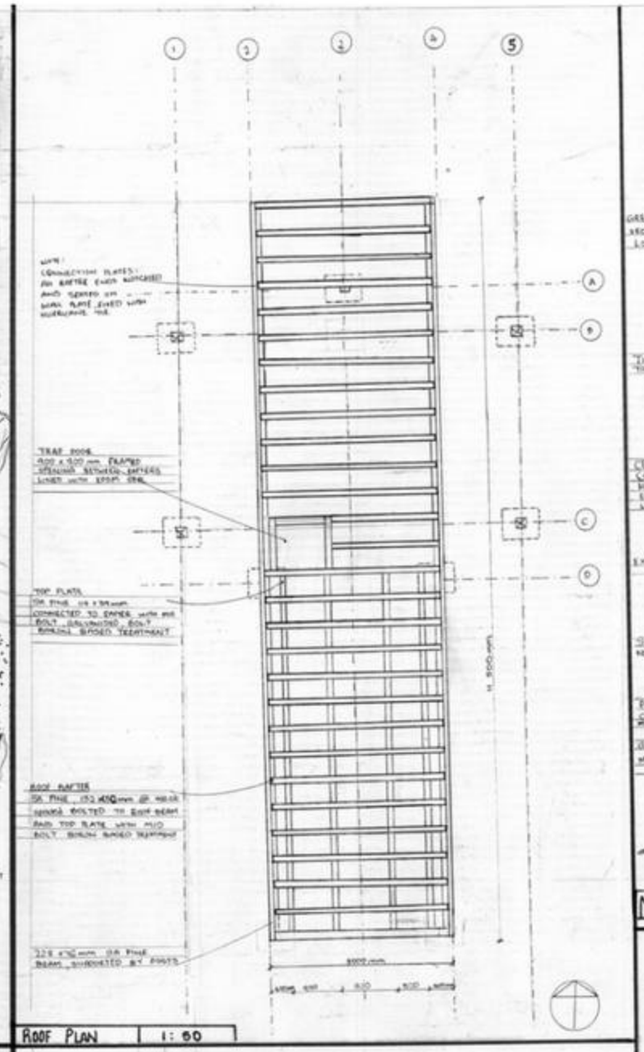




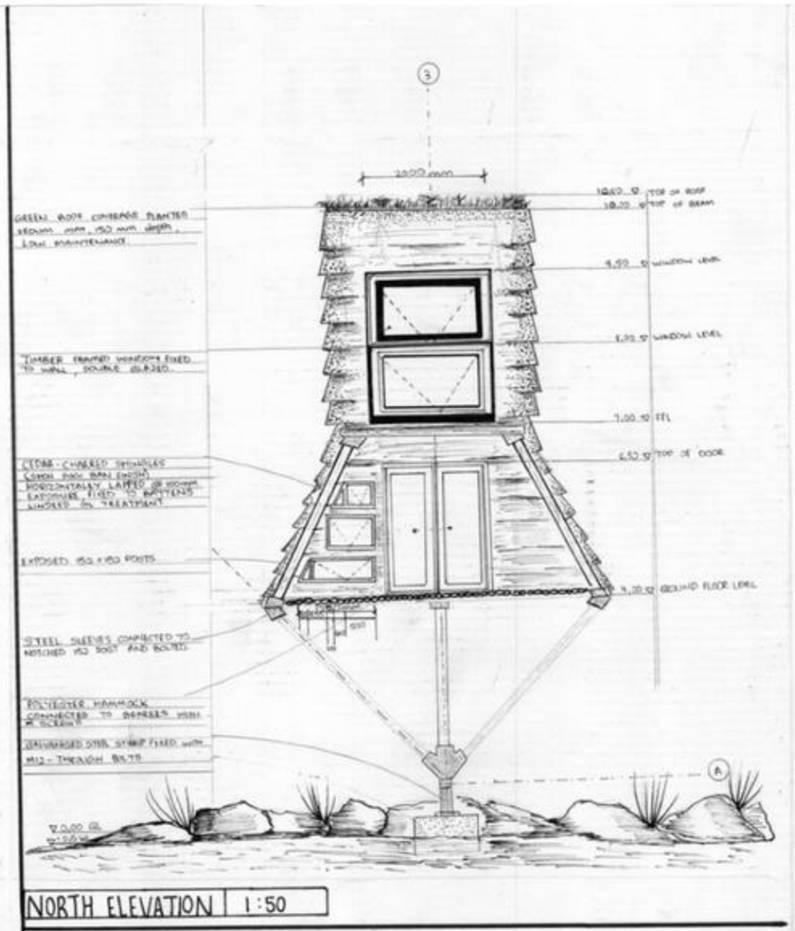


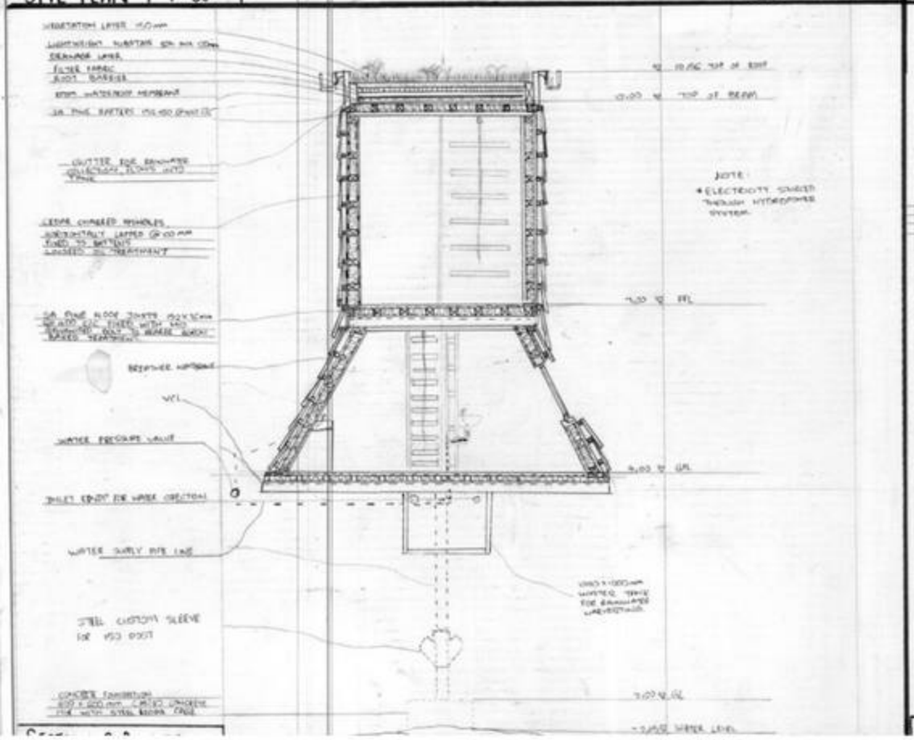
SITE PLAN | 1:50

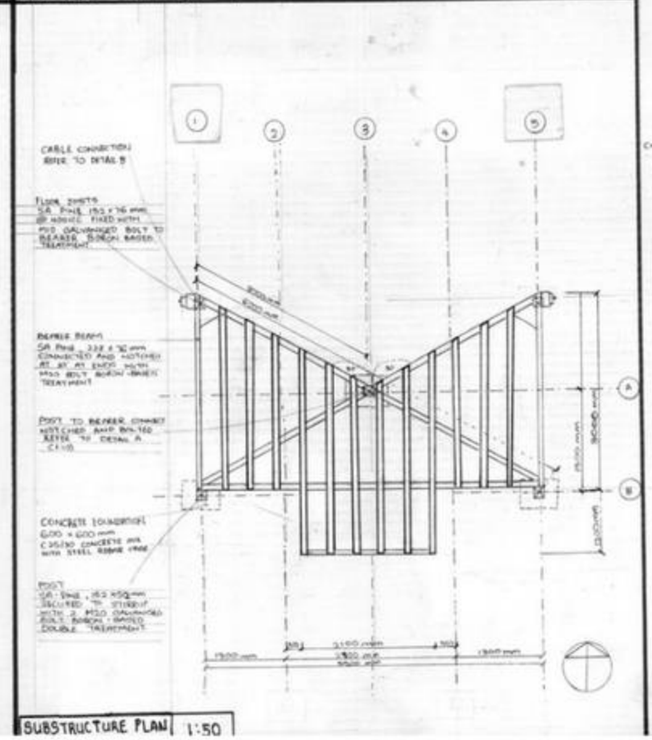


ROOF PLAN | 1:50

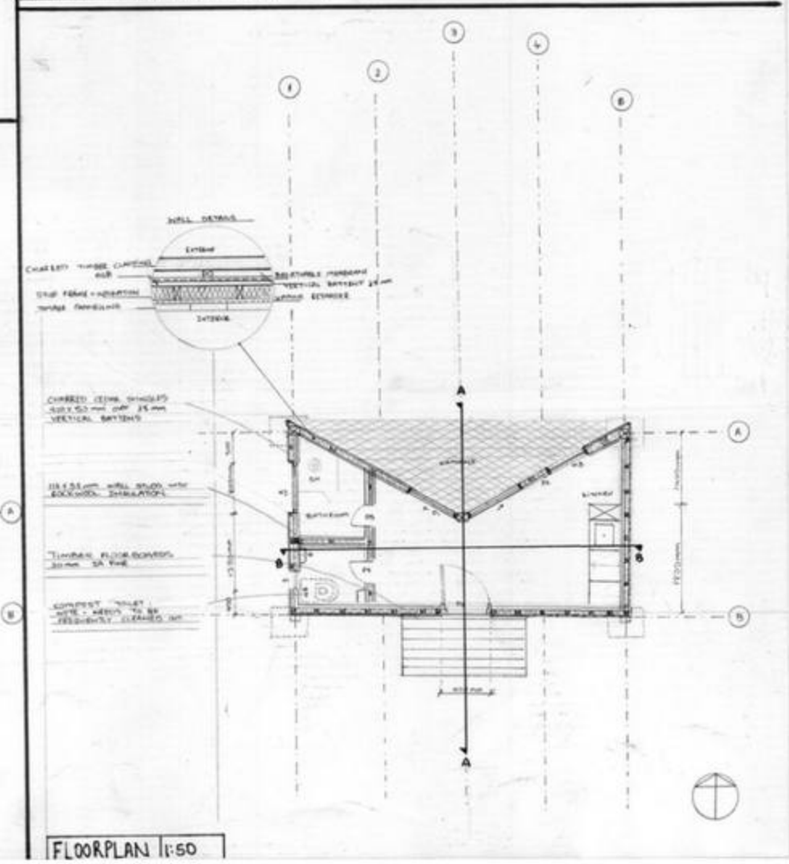


NORTH ELEVATION | 1:50





SUBSTRUCTURE PLAN | 1:50



FLOORPLAN | 1:50

PROJECT TITLE:

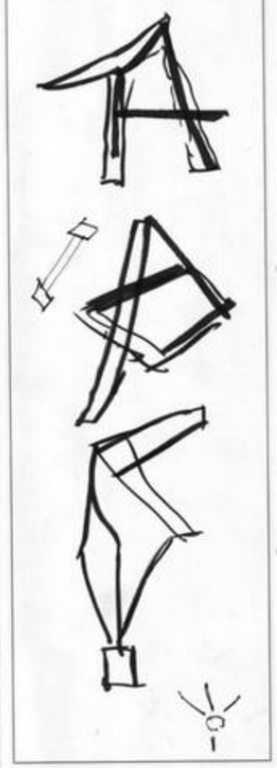
WATER, REST, PLACE

DESCRIPTION:

This design is rooted in the idea that architecture can have a soul — a presence — inspired by Peter Zumthor's writings and the spirit of Tsitsikamma itself.

There's something deeply atmospheric about this place, and I wanted to create a structure that responds to that presence. I designed the shelter with the experience of the hiker in mind. They enter from above, walking along the roof and discovering a trapdoor that leads down a ladder. The angled wall beside it allows them to slide their bags down as they climb down the ladder — a small moment of relief, a gesture of welcome. The main bedroom is placed on the top floor, because at the end of a long journey, hikers want to rest, to be still. The shelter reaches out over the river - facing the waterfall, half suspended in air. Beneath it, a hammock floats directly above the water, inviting stillness and connection. The angled walls mirror the fall of the water across the shelter, pulling hikers deeper into the landscape. Every joint and cable is intentional, each connection a response to the site. The angled descent wall was I inspired by the way I used to imagine sliding down a waterfall — playful, bold, and rooted in place.

CONCEPT SKETCHES:



ARPL2002A

THEORY & PRACTICE OF CONSTRUCTION II

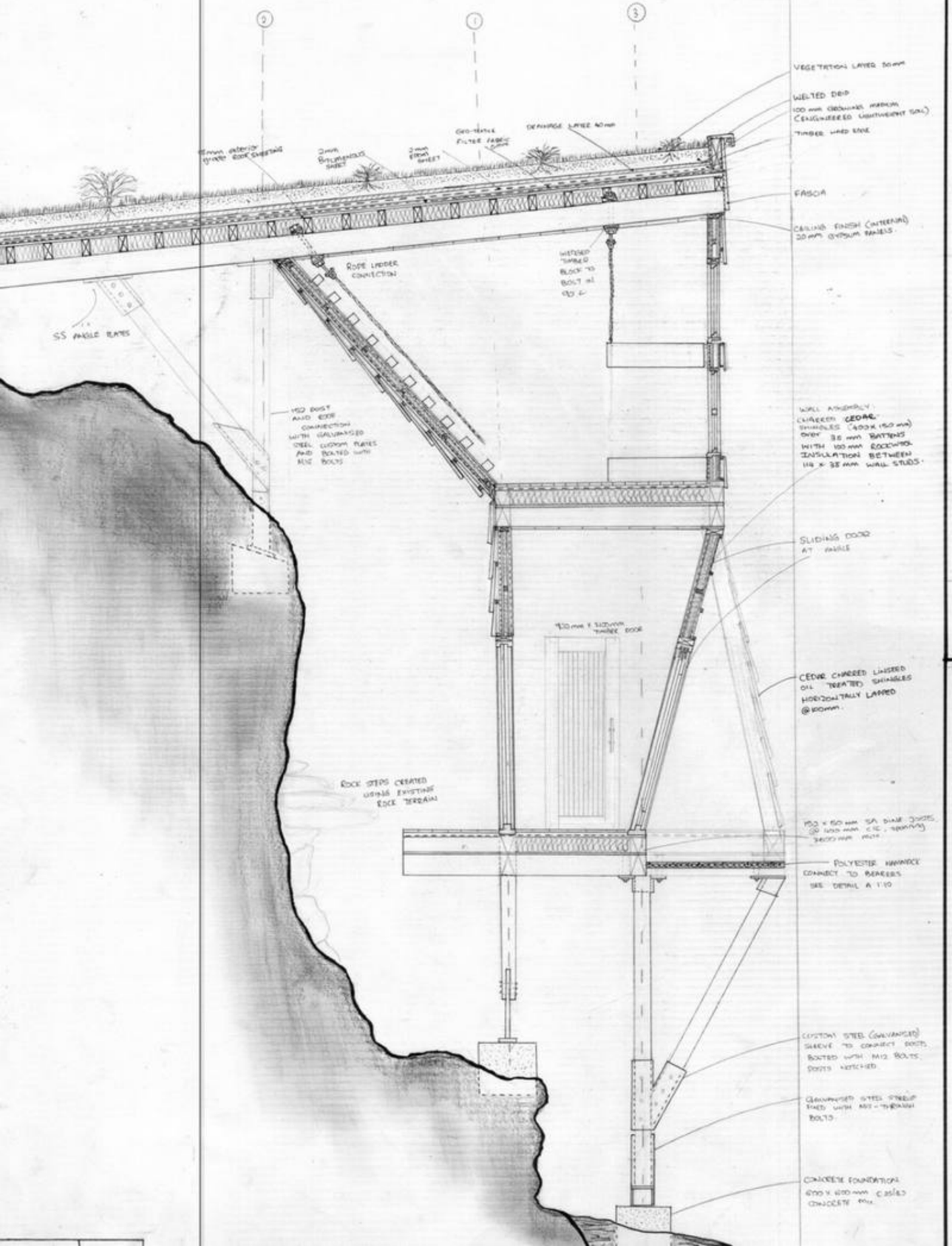
LEAVE NO TRACE:

AN OFF-GRID, PASSIVELY DESIGNED SHELTER IN THE TSITSIKAMMA FOREST

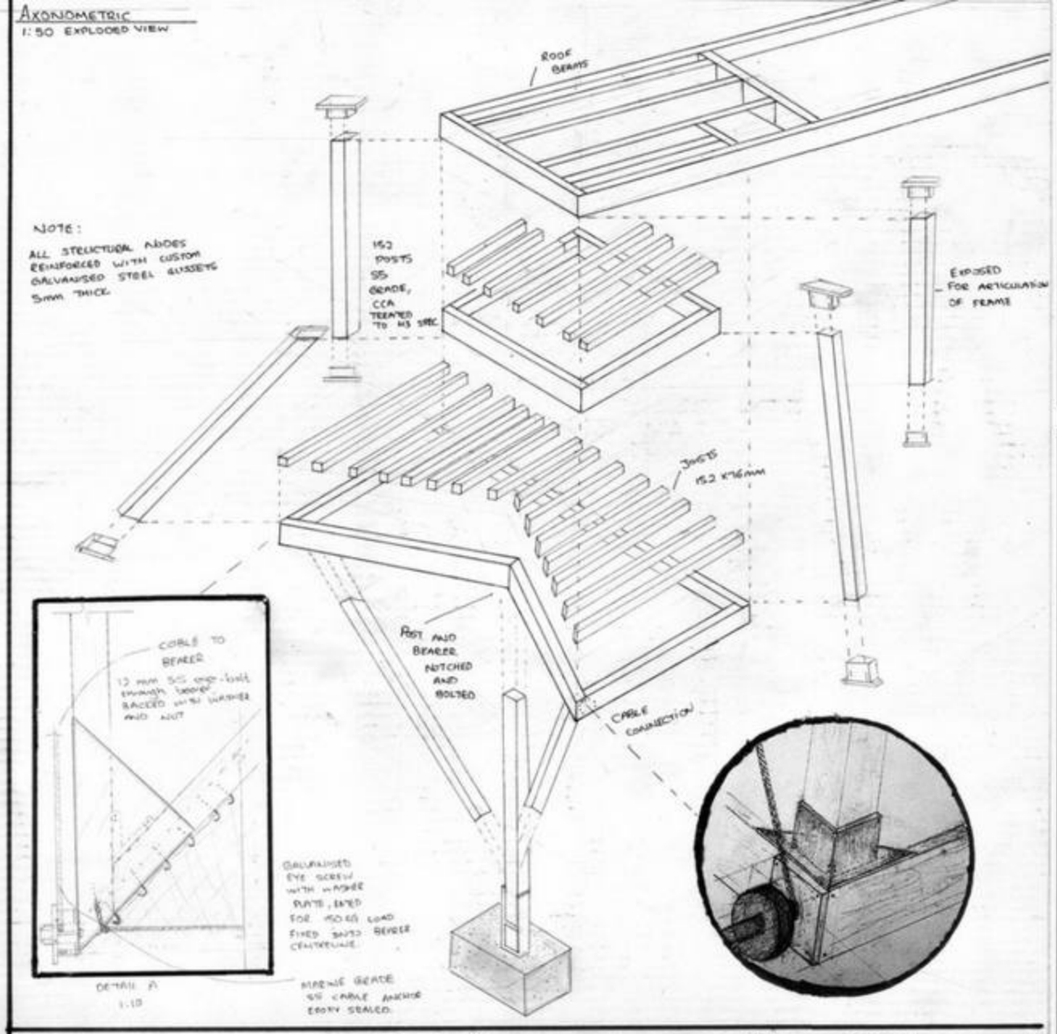
TAMAE SAISHA REDDY
2873377

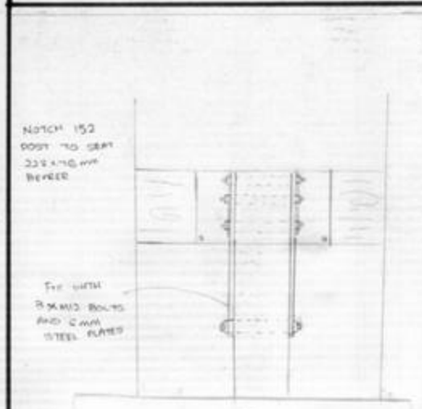
UNIVERSITY OF THE WITWATERSRAND JOHANNESBURG
SCHOOL OF ARCHITECTURE PLANNING

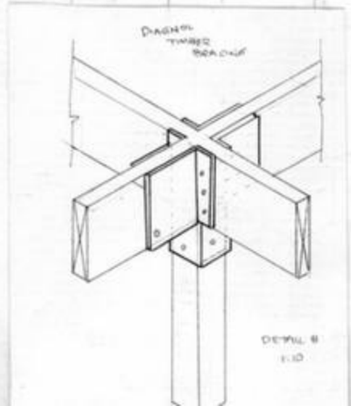
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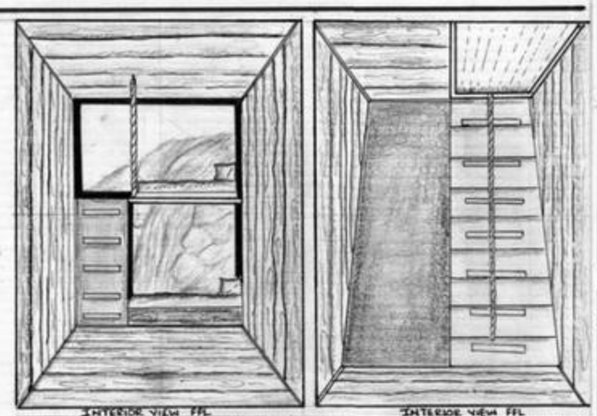


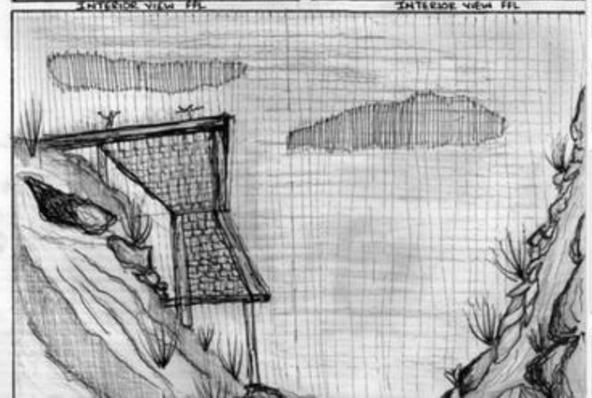
AXONOMETRIC
1:50 EXPLODED VIEW











PROJECT TITLE:

WATER, REST, PLACE

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CONCEPT SKETCHES:



ARPL2002A
THEORY & PRACTICE OF CONSTRUCTION II

LEAVE NO TRACE

AN OFF-GRID, PASSIVELY DESIGNED SHELTER IN THE TSITSIKAMMA FOREST

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UNIVERSITY OF THE WITWATERSRAND JOHANNESBURG
SCHOOL OF ARCHITECTURE & PLANNING

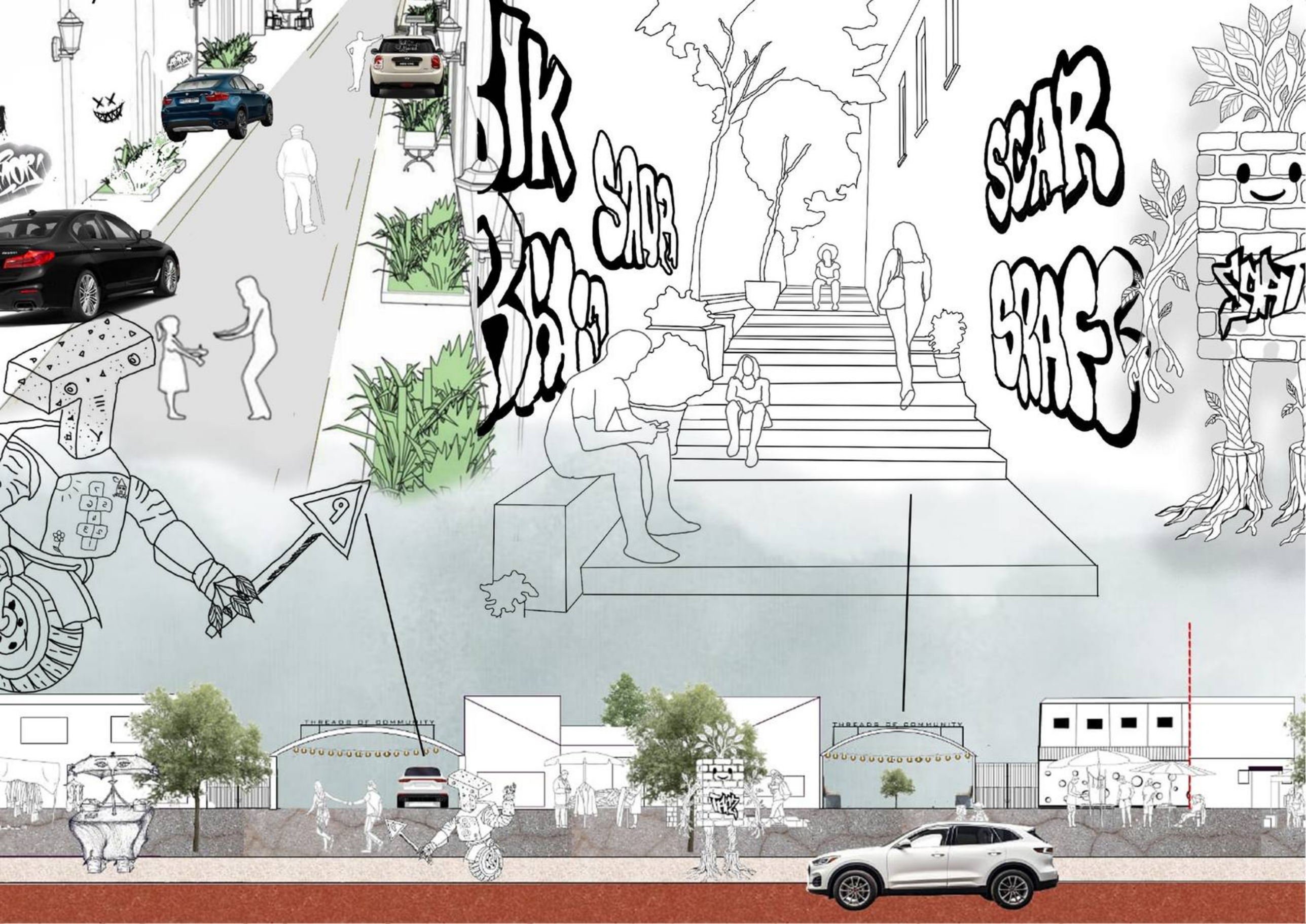


Y0S2

The Melville project explores housing as a framework for everyday life, focusing on how space can support both living and community. The design introduces public spaces between alleyways, transforming one into a mixed-use parking area and the other into a shared seating garden, creating active thresholds between adjacent social housing. These spaces connect to shared programmes, including workshops focused on skills development and worker's rights, allowing residents to engage in activities that support both learning and economic opportunity, culminating in a weekend market.

5th avenue

4th avenue


THREADS OF COMMUNITY
THREADS OF COMMUNITY



RENDER ALTERED USING AI AND PHOTOSHOP



GROUND FLOOR PLAN 1:100



FIRST FLOOR PLAN 1:100



MEZZANINE PLAN 1:100



RENDER ALTERED USING AI AND PHOTOSHOP

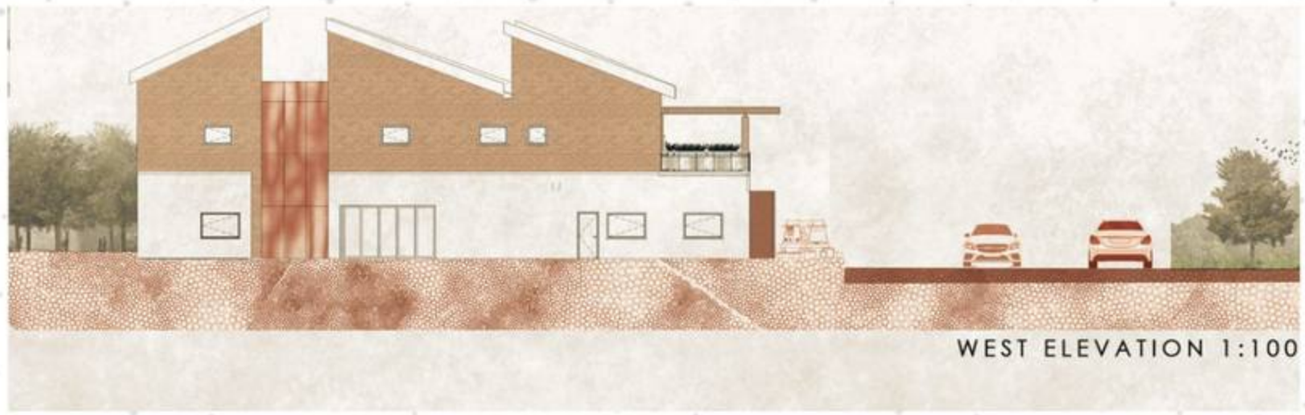


SECTION A-A





SOUTH ELEVATION 1:100



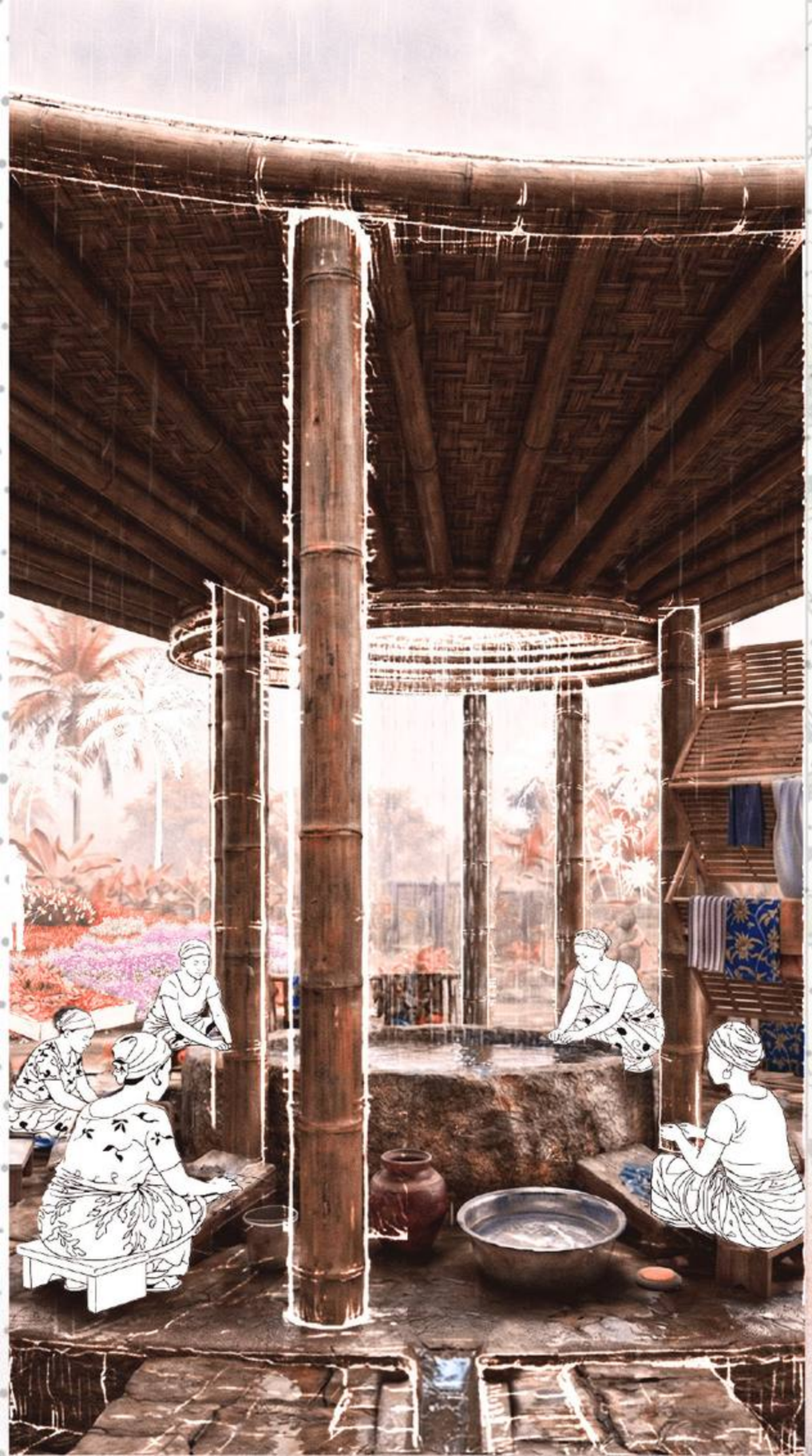
WEST ELEVATION 1:100



NORTH ELEVATION 1:100



EAST ELEVATION 1:100



KAIRA LOORO

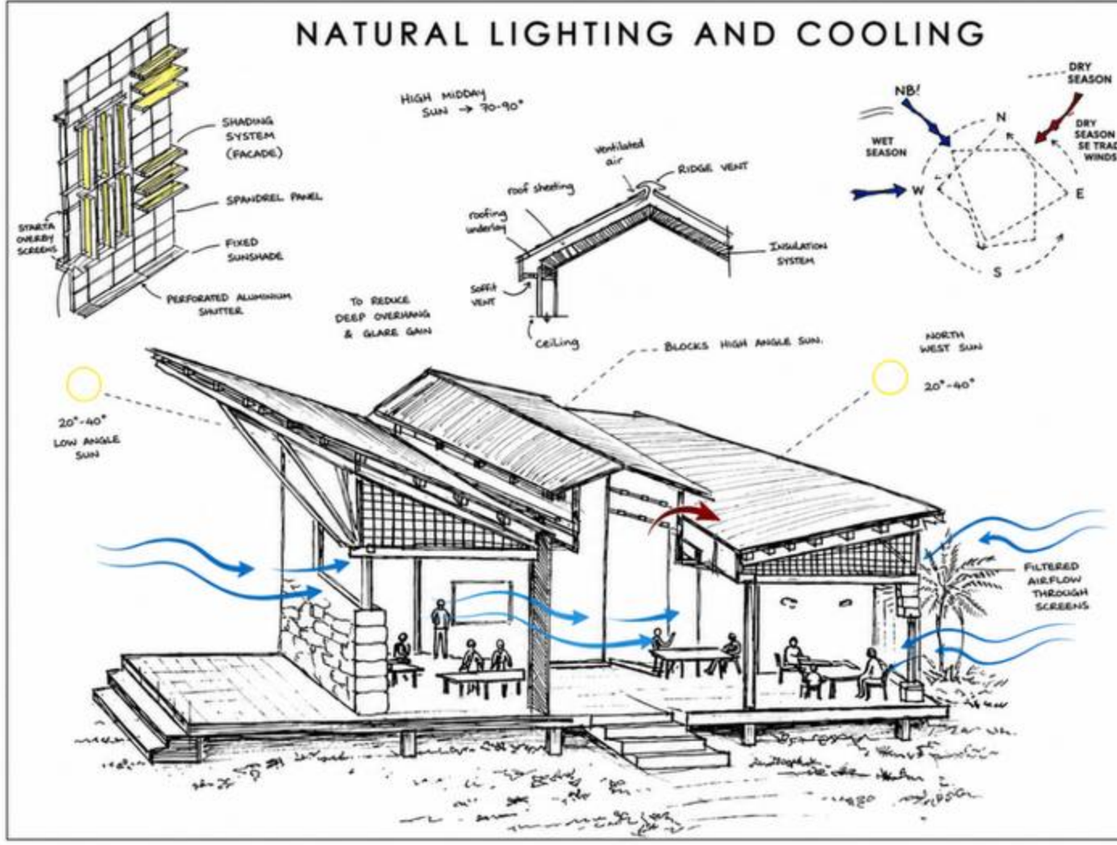
COMMUNITY CENTRE

DIAKENE OUOLOF, SENEGAL

Kër gu ñu bokk is a proposed community centre in Diakene Ouolof, Senegal, organised around a central rain-harvesting water court. The project explores how architecture can support everyday life and small-scale local economy through one connected spatial system. Programmes including washing, pottery and soap making, food growing, cooking, trade, learning, and community gathering are arranged around a shared core, allowing water to function as both environmental infrastructure and social anchor. The design focuses on climate-responsive form, simple material logic, and the relationship between productive activity, communal space, and collective self-sufficiency.

CONSTRUCTION CONCEPTUAL DRAWINGS

NATURAL LIGHTING AND COOLING



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Current Revision Issued

Rev Notes:

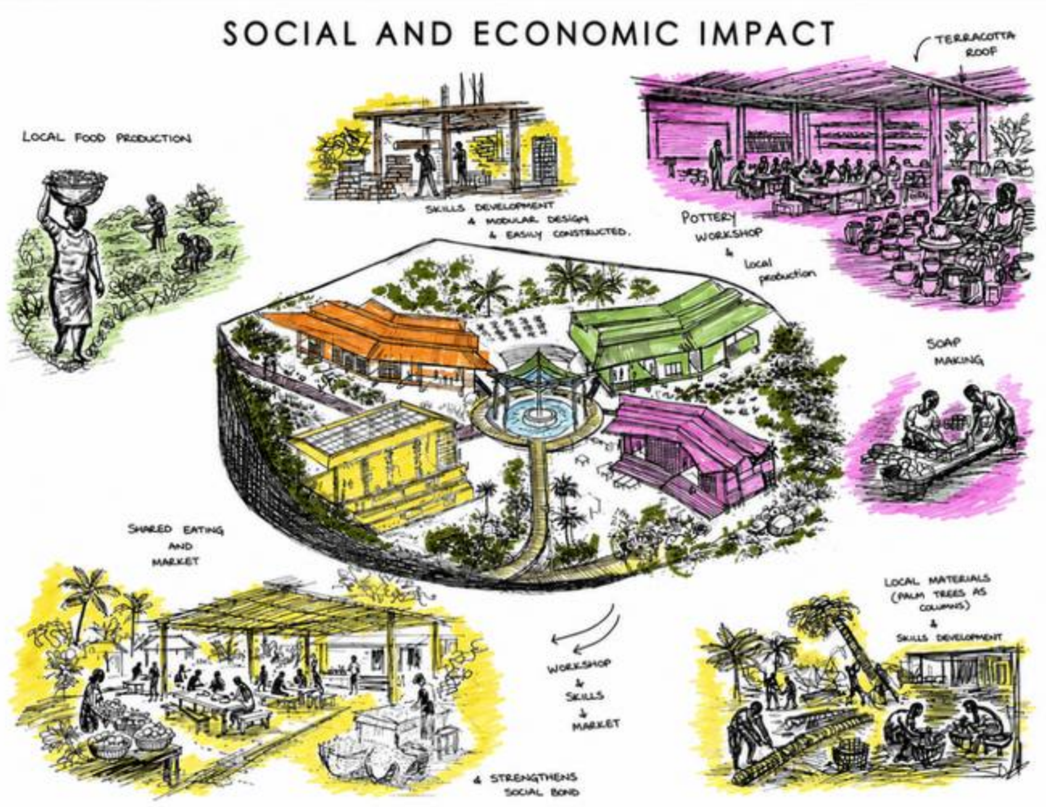
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NOTES:

REFER TO ENGINEER SPECIFICATIONS WHEN NOTED.
ALL FINAL DECISIONS MUST BE IN THE RELEVANT CONSULTANT OR ARCHITECT.
ALL DESIGNS AND DETAILS MUST ADHERE TO SANS 10400.

NATURAL LIGHTING AND COOLING
DRW
Project Address
Date Issued: 2025|05|18

SOCIAL AND ECONOMIC IMPACT



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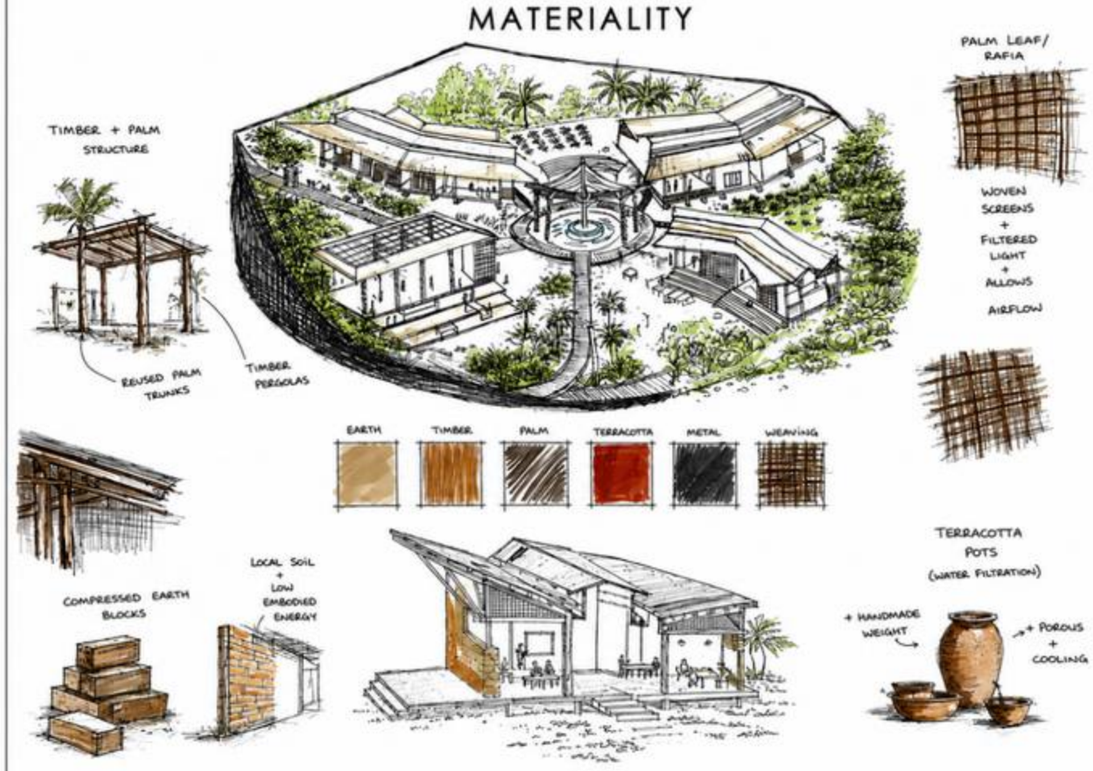
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SOCIAL AND ECONOMIC IMPACT
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MATERIALITY



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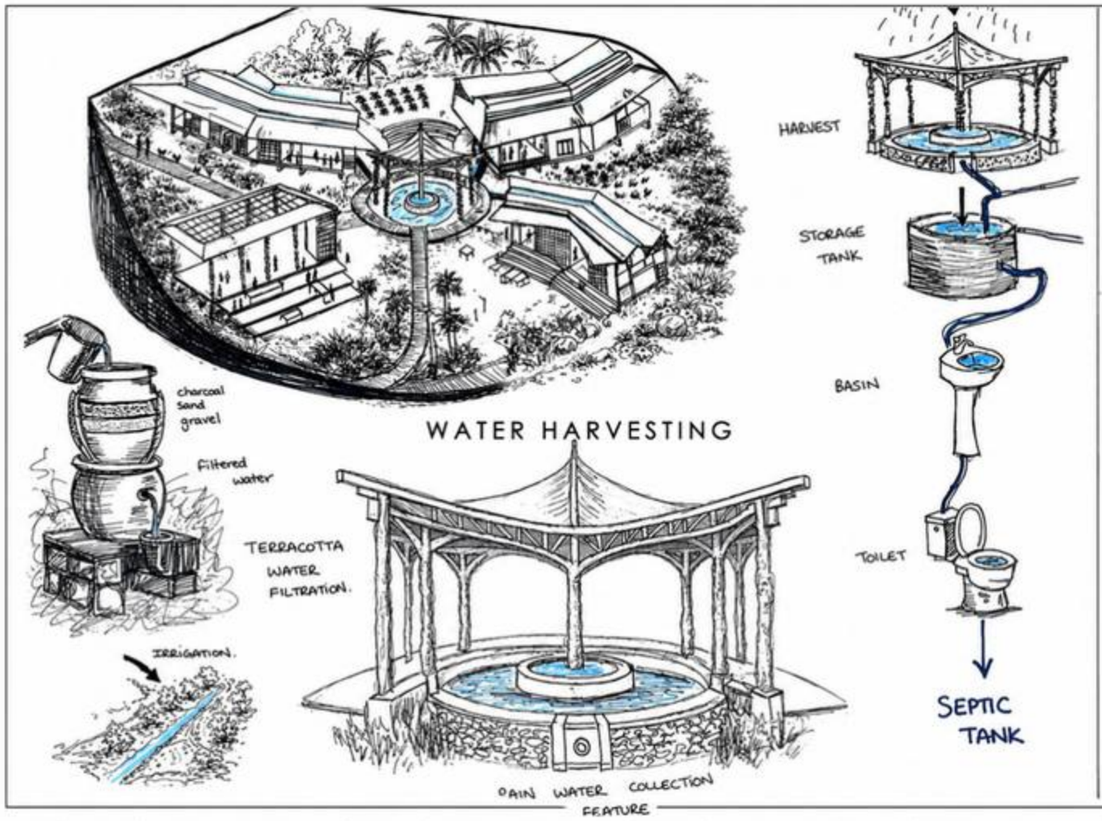
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MATERIALITY
DRW
Project Address
Date Issued: 2025|05|18

WATER HARVESTING



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Author
CHK
Current Revision Issued

Rev Notes:

No	

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MATERIALITY
DRW
Project Address
Date Issued: 2025|05|18



This stage of the project focused on grounding the proposal in the spatial, social, and material realities of Diakene Ouolof. The site mapping examined the relationship between the village fabric, routes, landscape, and the placement of the community centre at the settlement edge. Alongside this, I developed diagrams exploring the project's social and economic cycle — showing how rainwater harvesting, washing, pottery making, soap production, food growing, and gathering could operate as one connected communal system. The materiality study tested how local resources and low-tech construction methods could inform the architecture, linking the proposal's environmental strategy to its structural and economic logic.





FLOORPLAN 1:200

1. MARKET SPACE
2. OUTDOOR EATING AREA
3. KITCHEN
4. CLASSROOM 1
5. CLASSROOM 2
6. STORAGE
7. LIBRARY AND STUDY
8. WATER HARVESTING
9. COMMUNITY HALL
10. POTTERY AND SOAP WORKSHOP
11. HARVEST GARDEN
12. ALCOVES FOR SHELVES/SEATING
13. NOTICE BOARD



Kër Gu Ñu bokk

home

where we belong to together

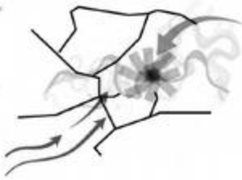
RENDER ALTERED USING AI AND PHOTOSHOP



1. LOCATING WITHIN THE VILLAGE



2. LINKING THROUGH EXISTING PATHS



3.ORIENTING TO SEASONAL WINDS



4. PROGRAMMING



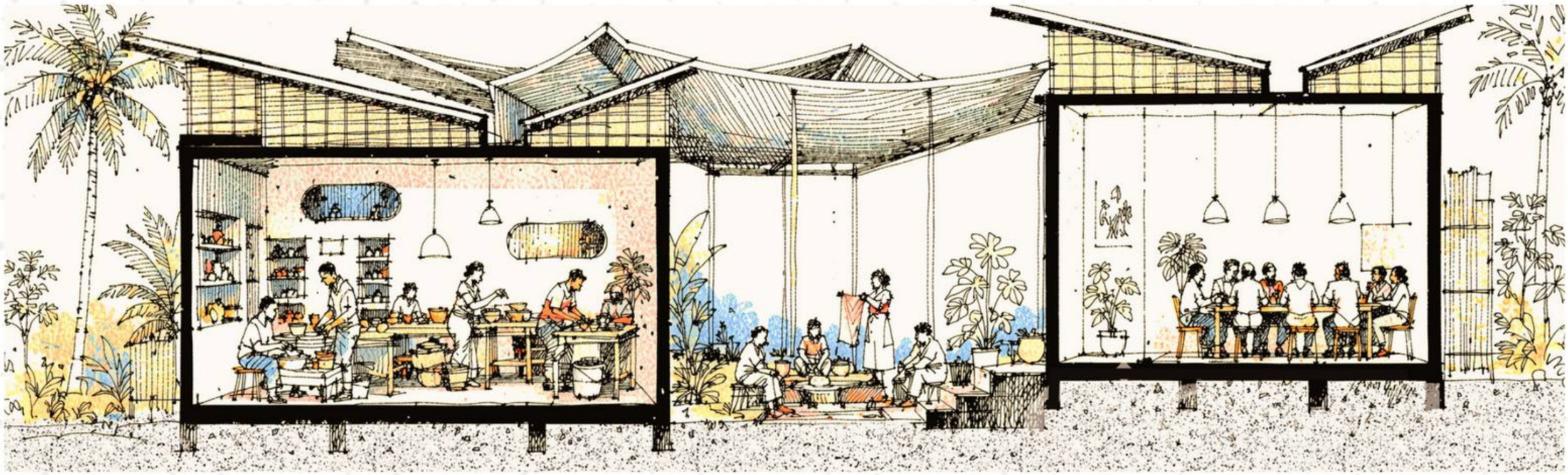
5.BALANCING MASS AND POROSITY



6. INTERGRATION WITH SITE



This spread examines the spatial character of the project through interior visualization and section. The workshop render emphasises making as a central programme within the community centre, while the sectional drawing reveals how productive, social, and communal spaces are organised around the shared central court. The combination of these views was used to test atmosphere, materiality, and occupation, showing how the architecture supports everyday labour, exchange, and gathering within one connected system.



ENGLISH LESSON – BASIC COMMUNICATION

Greetings
- Hello
- Good morning
- Good afternoon

Introducing yourself
- My name is _____
- I am from _____
- I am a student

Asking questions
- What is your name?
- Where are you from?
- How are you?

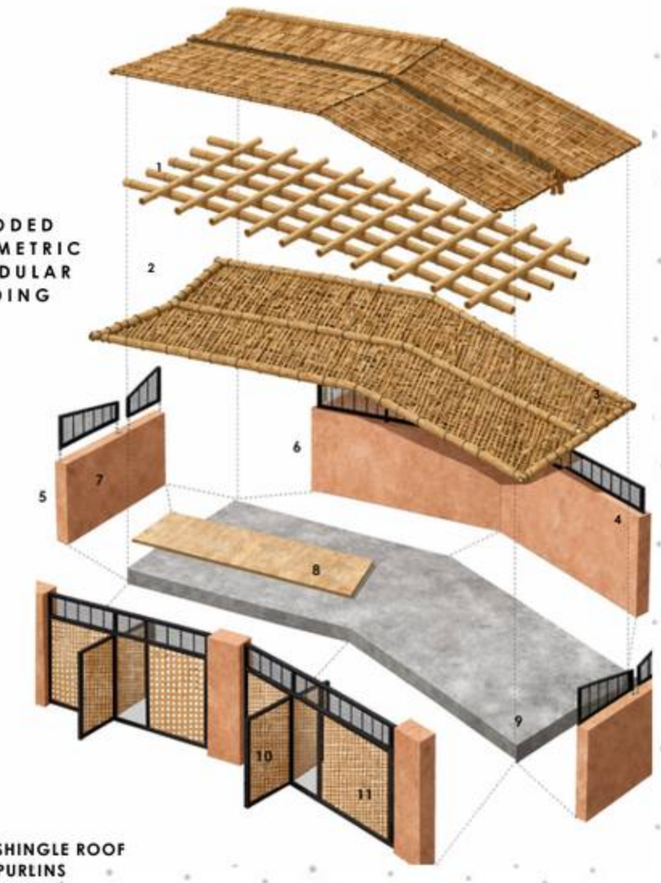
Responses
- I am fine
- I am good
- I am tired

Practice:

Fill in the blanks: 1. My name is_____
1. My name is _____ 2. I am from _____
3. I am _____ (fine / good / tired).

"My name is Ava. I am from Senegal. I am learning English."

EXPLODED AXONOMETRIC OF MODULAR BUILDING



1. BAMBOO SHINGLE ROOF
2. BAMBOO PURLINS
3. BAMBOO RAFTERS
4. WOVEN BAMBOO CEILING / SCREEN LAYER
5. WALL + VENTILATION
6. HIGH-LEVEL VENTILATION SCREEN
7. ADOBE WALL
8. MUD FLOOR FINISH
9. MUD FLOOR MASS
10. PIVOTING BAMBOO SCREEN DOORS
11. BAMBOO SCREEN PANELS



1:10 PERIMETER SECTION MODEL



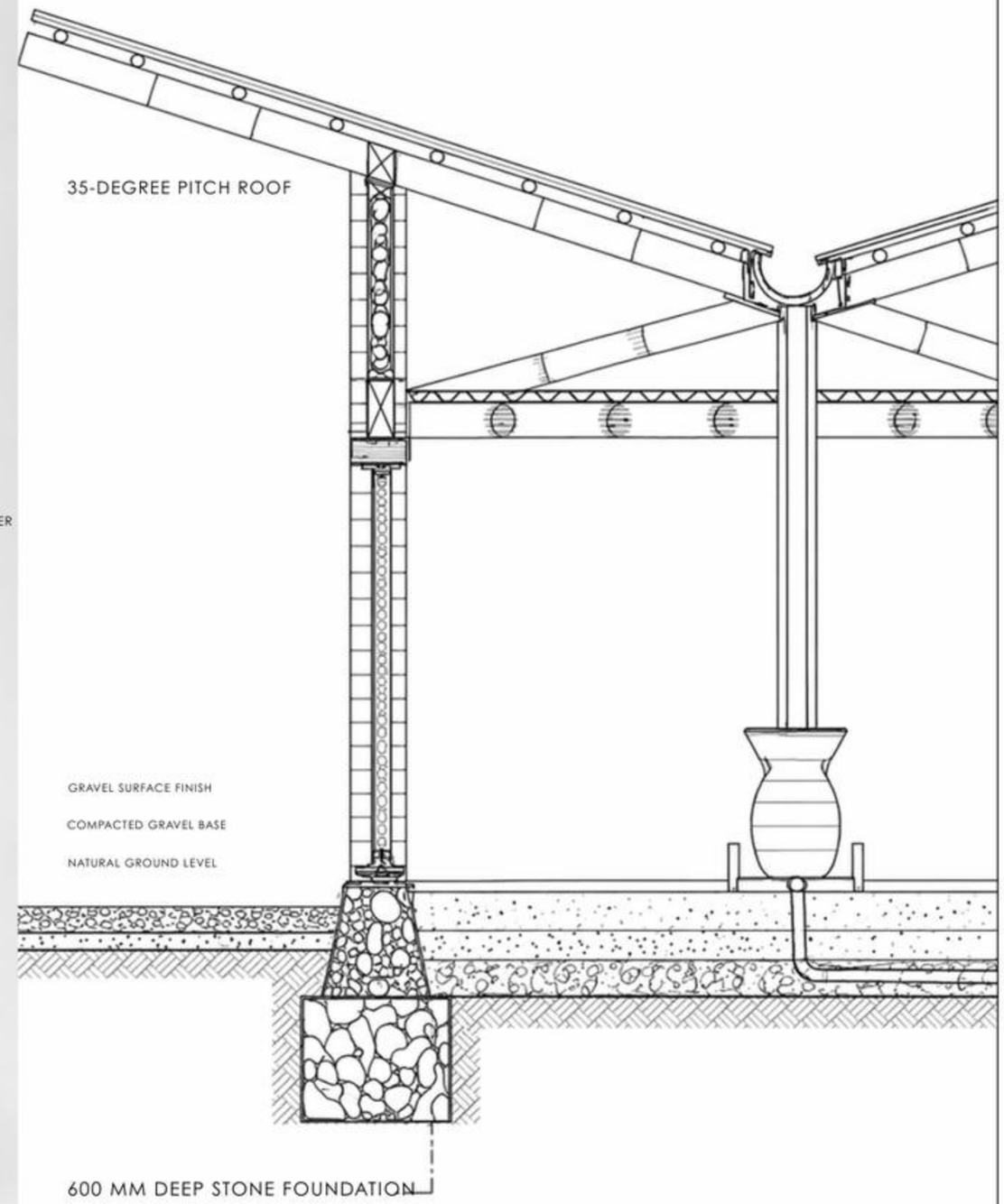




1:10 PERIMETER SECTION MODEL



1:25 PERIMETER SECTION



GI-LINED WATERPROOF GUTTER
HALF-ROUND GUTTER CONCEALED WITHIN BAMBOO HOUSING

50MM BAMBOO ROOF SHEETING

BAMBOO BATTENS
150–200 MM SPACING

BAMBOO PURLINS
300–400 MM SPACING

CONTINUOUS WATERPROOF MEMBRANE TURNED INTO GUTTER

Ø80–100 MM TREATED BAMBOO RAFTERS @ 700 MM CENTRES
FIXED TO TIMBER RING BEAM

1200 MM VENTILATED ROOF CAVITY
DOUBLE ROOF SYSTEM FOR PASSIVE COOLING

WOVEN BAMBOO CEILING
BREATHABLE INTERNAL CEILING LAYER

BAMBOO-CLAD DOWNPIPE
Ø90 MM RAINWATER DOWNPIPE

WATER FILTRATION SYSTEM
RAINWATER COLLECTION DOWNPIPE
TERRACOTTA FILTRATION VESSEL
PEBBLE LAYER
REMOVES LARGE DEBRIS
GRAVEL LAYER
SECONDARY FILTRATION
SAND LAYER
FINE SEDIMENT REMOVAL
CHARCOAL LAYER
WATER PURIFICATION
OVERFLOW / DRAIN PIPE
DIRECTS FILTERED WATER TO STORAGE OR IRRIGATION

BURNISHED CLAY FLOOR FINISH
10 MM

MUD PLASTER LAYER
30 MM

COMPACTED EARTH LAYER
100 MM

HARDCORE STONE BASE
100 MM

COMPACTED SUBGRADE
150 MM

DAMP PROOF COURSE (DPC)
CONTINUOUS MOISTURE BARRIER BENEATH WALL

RAISED STONE PLINTH
450 MM HIGH
PROTECTS ADOBE FROM SPLASHBACK AND RISING DAMP



SAOTA STUDENT INTERNSHIP 2026

Internship

FAMILY RESIDENCE

MONTENEGRO, BUDVA

Designing a timber hiking shelter taught me how structure, material, and landscape work together. This project helped me connect deeply with the environment through making and material honesty.

Conceptual Sketches





CYPRUS TREES PLANTED DELIBRITELY TO BREAK COASTAL WIND AND DEFINE ENTRANCES







DRY STONE LANDSCAPE WALLS

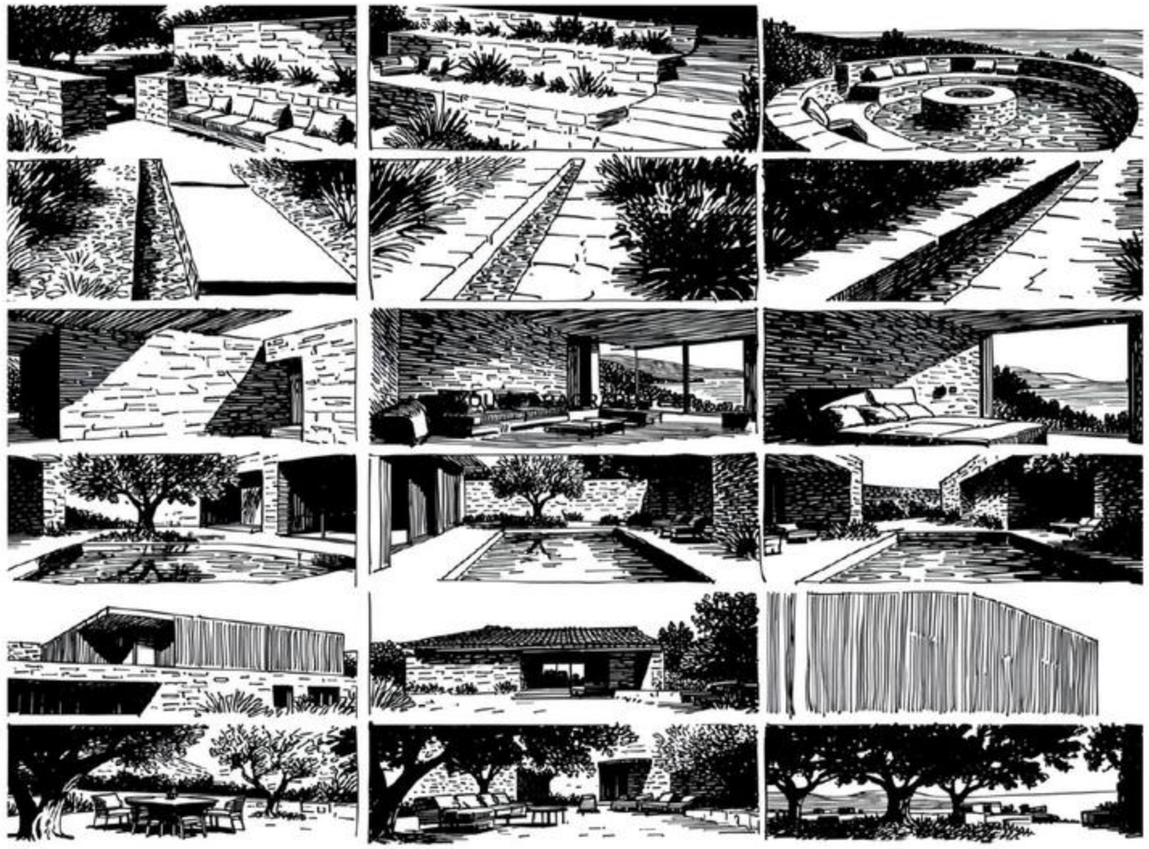






ЦРКВА СВЕТОГ САВЕ, RIJEKA REŽEVIĆI, MONTENEGRO





UNDERSTANDING THE VERNACULAR

MNE_BUD_THE HEARTH

BUDVA, MONTENEGRO



TERRAIN AS STRUCTURE

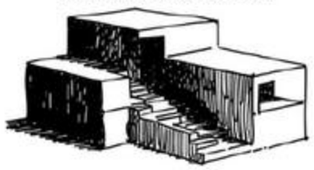


BETWEEN LAND AND SEA



FRAMED HORIZON















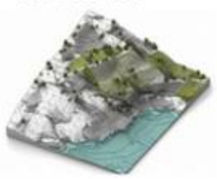
EXISTING CONDITIONS

↓

LANDSCAPE



TOPOGRAPHY



COMMUNITY



VEGETATION



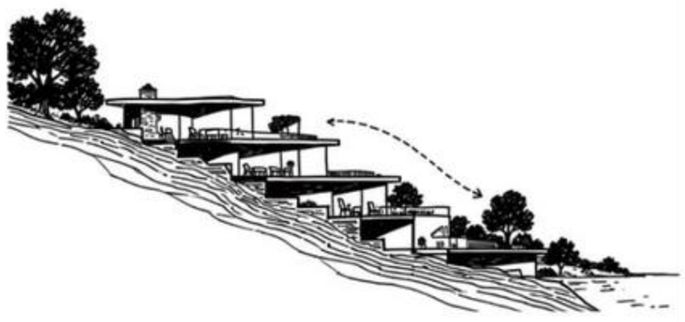
VIEWS



DESIGN RESPONSES

↓

TERRACED LIVING





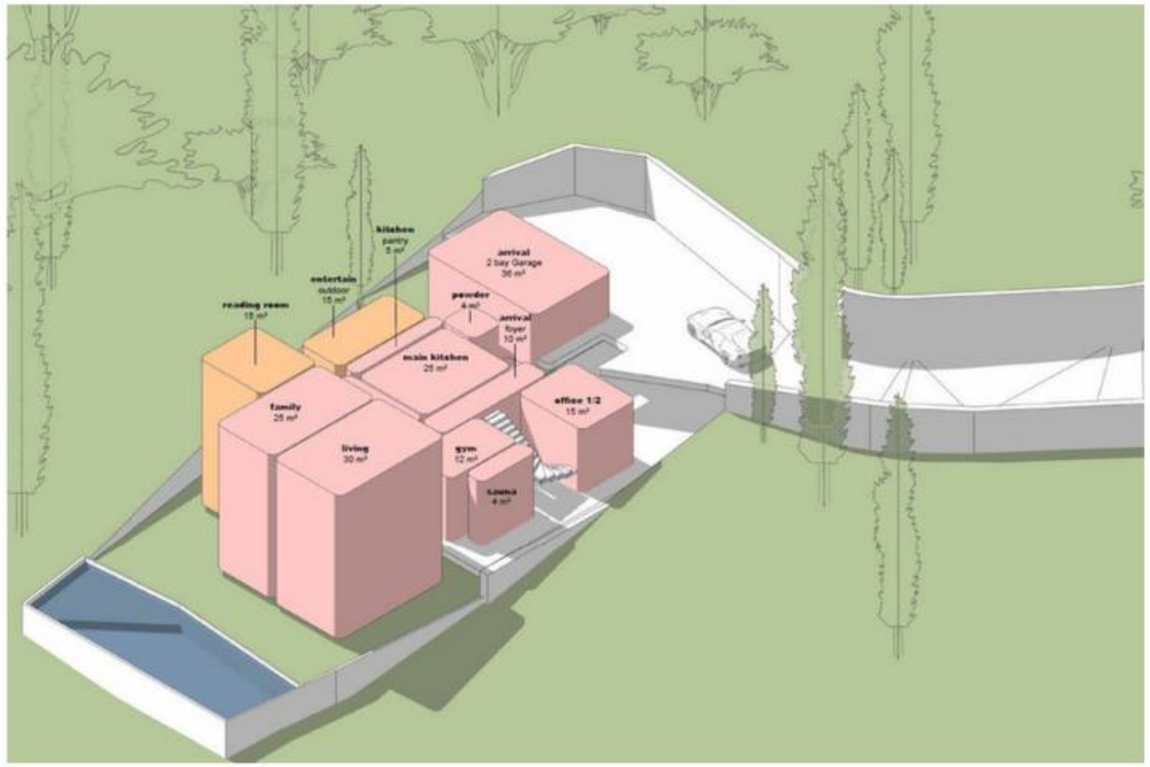
INDOOR–OUTDOOR LIVING



FRAMING VIEWS

SAOTA









PROGRAMMATIC THEMES

MNE_BUD_THE HEARTH

BUDVA, MONTENEGRO

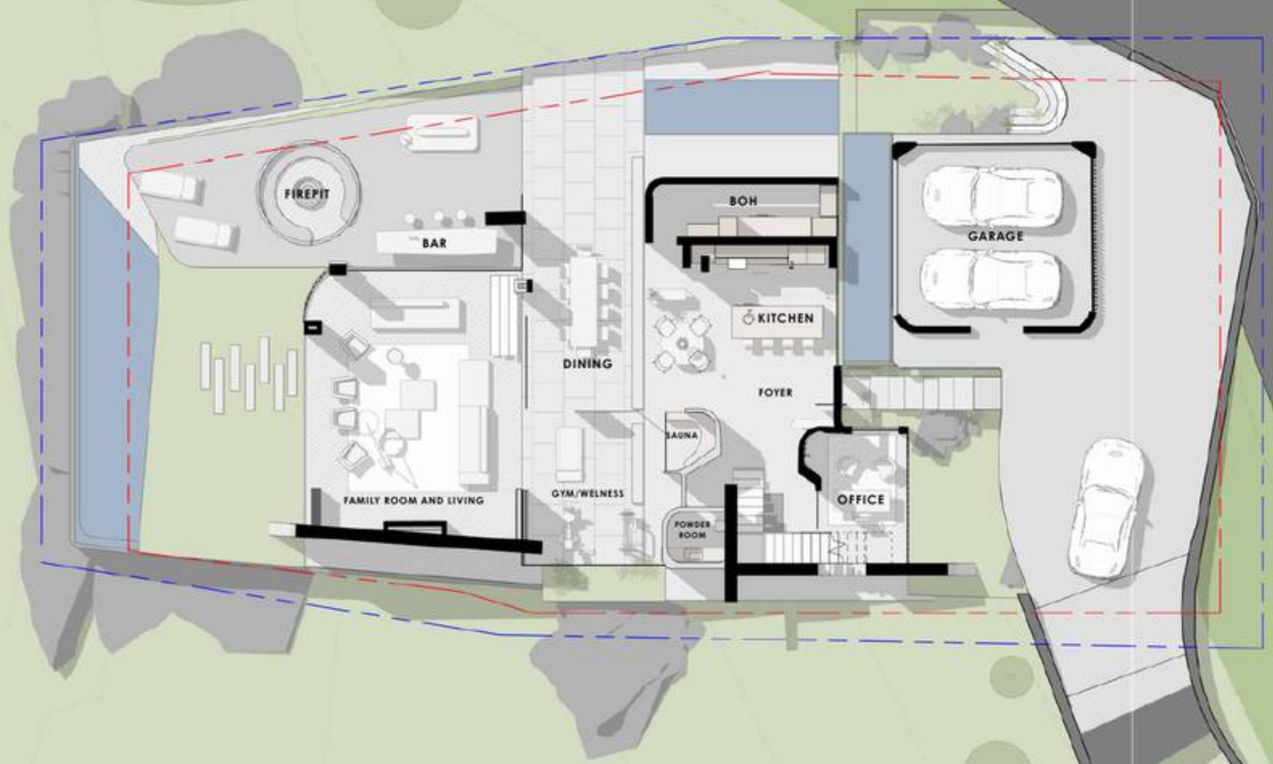
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SITE PLAN

N

SAOTA



0 4000 8000mm

SCALE 1:200

GROUND FLOOR

MNE_BUD_THE HEARTH

MONTENEGRO, BUDVA

N

SAOTA



FIRST FLOOR

MNE_BUD_THE HEFE ARTH

MONTENEGRO, BUDVA

SAOTA



1 A_2000_North
1 : 200

2 A_2000_South
1 : 200

0 4 8m

NORTH AND SOUTH ELEVATIONS

MNE_BUD_THE HEARTH

SAOTA



A_2000_West

1 : 200



A_2000_East

1 : 200

EAST AND WEST ELEVATIONS
MNE_BUD_THE HEARTH

SAOTA



2 **Section BB**
1 : 200

1 **Section AA**
1 : 200

SECTION AA AND BB
MNE_BUD_THE HEARTH

SAOTA

ROOF LEVEL



FIRST FLOOR



GROUND FLOOR



0 4

AXONOMETRICS

MNE_BUD_THE HEARTH

SAOTA



3D VIEW

MNE_BUD_THE HEARTH

BUDVA, MONTENEGRO

SAOTA

REF: ProjectName_WS02_03_1302_IDC_Doc1A2_1EM



3D VIEW INTERIOR

MNE_BUD_THE HEARTH

BUDVA, MONTENEGRO

SAOTA

REF: ProjectName_WS02_03_1502_IDC_Doc1A2_1EM



3D VIEW

MNE_BUD_THE HEARTH

BUDVA, MONTENEGRO

SAOTA

REF: ProjectName_WS02_03_1002_IDC_Doc1A2_TEM

@arch.tamae

THANK YOU!

